empire, lowering Russia's mid-nineteenth-century border at Tashkent and Samarkand to within a few hundred miles of British India. In 1828, when Persia opened Tehran to a Russian deputation, British strategists feared the frost of Russia's glacier advancing toward Kabul. "We have long declined to meddle with the Afghans," Britain's Lord Palmerston warned, "but if the Russians try to make them Russian, we must take care they become British."[2] A decade later British India launched its "glorious" Army of the Indus over the Khyber to take Kabul, the first of their several futile attempts to conquer Afghanistan, from which they were forced to flee in desperation three years later, all shot dead before any Anglo-Indian soldiers reached home.

So when Soviet tanks and troops moved into Kabul at the end of 1979, installing their puppet Amir Babrak Karmal as the country's nominal ruler, Washington was as alarmed as was Islamabad. Pakistan's intense anxiety was easy enough for the United States to understand, it having been engaged since the end of World War II in the Cold War with Moscow. But India's reaction to the Soviet advance was ambivalent, not only because Indira Gandhi had just recently signed her treaty of friendship with Moscow, but also since Pakistan's Zia was so aggressively a fundamentalist Muslim, eager to arm and support thousands of Pathan mujahideen (jihadist) guerrillas, backed by the CIA, the Pentagon, and the White House. Indira was reluctant, therefore, to condemn the Soviet invasion as most of the world denounced it at the United Nations, voting instead to abstain rather than to support so clear an act of international bullying. New Delhi's military leaders, however, warned Gandhi of the obvious dangers of a powerful Soviet force sitting on South Asia's vulnerable frontier, for if ever they did come rumbling down the Khyber, there was precious little to stop Soviet tanks from rolling on toward New Delhi itself, before which they might even be joined by Pakistan's army.

India's oldest text on realpolitik, the *Arthaśāstra*, early taught Delhi's monarchs that one's neighbor was always "the enemy," while one's "neighbor's neighbor" was always "the friend"—or at least should be. India and Pakistan have, therefore, long had classical adversarial roles toward Afghanistan. In the era of General Zia's rule, that conflict intensified as four million Afghan refugees poured into Pakistan, where they received not only food and shelter, but also arms from Islamabad's leaders, who viewed Indira Gandhi as the USSR's best friend in Kabul and Kandahar. Throughout the decade of Soviet dominance in Afghanistan, Pakistan, with massive U.S. military aid and money, trained